POLITICAL SCIENCE AND INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Even though IR has to be treated as a 'bundle of subject' yet, more often controversy unfolds between the discipline of Political Science and IR. One treats the other as an offshoot or rather part of its own discipline, while the other claims to be an autonomous discipline. It is truly very difficult to compartmentalize both Political Science and IR, as both are inextricably related to one another, and such controversies must be avoided. For a more matured and holistic study, both have to work hand-in-hand. What can be done is to look at the emphasis of both and levels of entry of one another into the discipline of each other. Political Science, if it is treated as a science of politics and working towards studying formal and informal political patterns existing in a particular state, IR is more concerned with trans-territorial affairs of the state. Political Science involves concern with politics within the territorial unit that is called the State. The legislative, executive and judicial actions of a political system affecting the political life of a state are the core areas of concern of Political Science. Very little is the emphasis on foreign relations of the state concerned and comes into discussion when it affects the national policies mainly. IR, on the other hand, is more concerned with the external relations of the states and studying the politics of power bargaining at the international level. Individual foreign policies of states, bilateral and multilateral engagements, interactions with trans-national non-state actors, conflict and cooperation, questions of international peace and security become the main concern of IR. However, it is not possible to draw an iron curtain between these two disciplines. It is not possible to study domestic politics totally disregarding the international politics, as international agreements and even international organizations might affect the national economic and political policies of State. Similarly, IR is also touched by domestic politics. The ruling government or regime, the bureaucrats, the political parties and public opinion come to have an impact on the external relations of the State. For example, the IMF, World Bank and WTO known as the Triad in international political economy, with their policies of Structural Adjustment Programmes (SAPs) affect the economic and financial policies of the countries,